

4 Religious language	4.1	Analogy and Symbol a) Analogy: <i>via negativa</i>, knowledge about God may be gained by what God is not like, univocal language and problems of anthropomorphism, equivocal language and problems of attribution, significance of proportional similarities and dissimilarities. With reference to the ideas of Aquinas. b) Symbol: types of symbol across a range of religious traditions, distinction between signs and symbols, symbols identifying and participating in a concept. Problems interpreting symbols and their limited application to a particular faith context. With reference to the ideas of P Tillich.
	4.2	Verification and falsification debates (2) (3) a) Context of Logical Positivism and the Vienna Circle, analytic and synthetic statements, implications for the claim that religious language is meaningless; view that religious claims are false because nothing can count against them; 'bliks' as unfalsifiable ways of framing our interpretation of the world compared to beliefs that are significant articles of faith which may be significantly challenged but not easily abandoned. b) Strengths and weakness of these approaches, including realist and anti-realist views and eschatological verification. With reference to the ideas of A J Ayer and B Mitchell.
	4.3	Language games a) Critique of picture theory, functional uses of language in the context of a form of life. Non-cognitive interpretation of language and criteria of coherence in the relevant language game, highlights the distinctive character of religious language, significance of fideism in this context – language can only be understood in the context of faith. With reference to the ideas of L Wittgenstein and D Phillips.